

BRIAN SCHMIDT AND SAUL PERLMUTTER

Born 1967 and 1959

Einstein predicted dark energy, but then dismissed it as a blunder.

Brian Schmidt

Saul Perlmutter

Brian Schmidt and Saul Perlmutter led rival teams that were trying to measure how distant galaxies in the expanding Universe were slowing down under the influence of gravity. In 1998, to their amazement, they found that the expansion of the Universe is actually speeding up. It has since been worked out that this is being caused by a mysterious force called "dark energy".

DATA FILE



KEY DISCOVERY: The expansion of the Universe is speeding up



COUNTRY OF ORIGIN: United States



YEAR OF DISCOVERY: 1998